

precautions and removed all obstructions, we can move on to removing and upgrading the CPU.

There are various forms of CPUs available, but upgrading only the CPU is an option available to users who have the current generation of CPUs, such as an Intel Pentium IV or an AMD Athlon or Duron. This is because only current-generation CPUs are available from dealers and retailers.

Another factor is the warranty on the processor. Older Pentium II and Pentium III processors are already out of warranty, so there will be no such processors available in the market in the first place for you to go and upgrade. In such cases, you will have to go in for a complete makeover, which will result in an almost new machine. Thinking of upgrading, you will fall in one of two categories, the first being a Pentium I, II or III or an equivalent AMD or Cyrix processor category. The second category would be a Pentium IV or an equivalent AMD processor category.

If you belong to the first category, upgrading the CPU will generally involve purchasing a second-hand, out-of-warranty CPU, and selling your old CPU for a not-so-good price. If you fall in the second category, you can get a spanking new processor with a warranty, and also a good resale value on your old processor.

In the first category, you will come across three different physical slot types. The first is Socket 7, applicable to Intel Pentium and AMD; then Slot 1, again applicable for three types of processors—Pentium II, Pentium III, and Celeron; and Slot A for the AMD Athlon Thunderbird series. There was a socket called Socket 370, created specifically for the Flip Chip Pin Grid Array (FCPGA) type of Pentium III and Celeron processors.

None of the processors mentioned above are available from retail stores and the only option you have is to either go for a new motherboard, processor and RAM, or settle for a second-hand deal, which is unviable because some time, you will have to upgrade.